



Executive Investment Committee Memo

Startup: AgriNova Malawi	Founder: Dr. Chimwemwe Phiri
Sector / Geo: AgTech / Supply Chain Malawi / SADC	Stage: Seed Date: August 17, 2026

EXECUTIVE INVESTMENT DECISION SNAPSHOT			
INVEST	Trust Score: 88/100	Conviction: 89% (HIGH)	Reliability: A
TOP INVESTMENT DRIVERS • AgriNova Malawi is an IC-ready AgTech platform delivering solar-powered cold chain and digital off-take solutions to 14,000+ smallholder farmers. The company demonstrates \$1.2M ARR, 310% YoY revenue growth, and grade-A evidence integrity. • INVEST — Allocate \$350K Seed check. AgriNova is the lead candidate in the OSTX AgTech cohort.		TOP FLAGGED RISKS • [MEDIUM] Corridor FX Exposure: Local currency (MWK) devaluation risk requires structured USD export off-take hedging.	
RECOMMENDED NEXT ACTION: Finalize term sheet for \$350K Seed allocation			

Founder	Startup	Market	Trust	Risk↓	Overall Score
90	87	89	88	22	86

1. Executive Summary & Thesis

AgriNova Malawi is an IC-ready AgTech platform delivering solar-powered cold chain and digital off-take solutions to 14,000+ smallholder farmers. The company demonstrates \$1.2M ARR, 310% YoY revenue growth, and grade-A evidence integrity.

2. Founder & Capability Assessment

Dr. Chimwemwe Phiri brings 12+ years of senior agronomic and operational experience. Outstanding digital footprint and high trust score across regional agricultural networks.

3. Startup Product & Operational Assessment

Validated B2B2C business model with high farmer retention rates, unit-positive margin structure, and clear competitive moat in solar cold storage.

4. Market Dynamics & Competition

Addressing a \$4.2B post-harvest loss market in Southern Africa, with strong tailwinds from climate-adaptation financing.

5. Risk Factors & Mitigations

Low regulatory risk in Malawi; primary risk is MWK currency volatility, mitigated by planned regional export corridors.

6. Final Investment Recommendation

INVEST — Allocate \$350K Seed check. AgriNova is the lead candidate in the OSTX AgTech cohort.

7. Actionable Next Steps

- Finalize term sheet for \$350K Seed allocation

2. Complete technical audit of solar cold-storage telemetry hardware
3. Structure FX buffer mechanism for cross-border revenues